later. By then, Everett had sobered up, and sheepishly admitted to the FBI agent that he had merely been playing a practical joke on the courier and marshals. He had inferred their profession when he overheard their chatter in the Dulles airport bar. The FBI agent, finally satisfied that no harm had been done and Everett was merely a man with a strange sense of humor, let Everett off with a warning and left him alone in his hotel room. Both the marshals and the FBI agent remained blissfully unaware that Everett himself had a security clearance that far outstripped their own.

Everett had done reasonably well for himself over the previous fifteen years since leaving Princeton and John Wheeler's tutelage. After eight years working directly for the Pentagon, he had struck out on his own, founding a statistical consulting firm and contracting for his former employers. His optimization algorithm had made his reputation at the Pentagon, and his work provided him with enough income for the finer things in life he enjoyed. He spent his days gaming out various scenarios for nuclear apocalypse and his evenings eating, smoking, and womanizing; he and his wife had agreed to an open marriage in the middle of the 1960s, though by then Everett had been conducting various short-lived affairs for years. By the time DeWitt and Wheeler invited him to the Austin conference in 1977, Everett was spending some of those evenings parked in front of his television with an early VCR, watching *Dr. Strangelove,* his favorite movie, on an endless loop, drink in hand.

Everett was pleased that DeWitt had brought new attention to his ideas. And it tickled him to see his own theory discussed in the pages of the same science-fiction magazines he had been reading all his life. "I certainly approve of the way Bryce DeWitt presented my theory," Everett wrote, "since without his efforts it would never have been presented at all." But it's not clear that Everett himself truly believed that the many worlds implied by his interpretation were literally real, as DeWitt did. Shortly after leaving Princeton, Everett corresponded with Philipp Frank, a founding member of the positivist Vienna Circle. Their letters reveal that the two men shared similar philosophical inclinations. "I find that you have expressed a viewpoint which is very nearly identical with the one which I have developed independently in the last few years, concerning the nature of physical theory," Everett wrote to Frank in 1957. Everett's dissatisfaction with Copenhagen had less to do with any commitment to realism and more